



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

OCT 2017

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October

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist
Church,
published each month.

The deadline for October is

October 20

Contributions may be brought to
the office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

SUNDAY WORSHIP -SUMMER SCHEDULE

9:00 am	Worship with organ and choir.
10:00am	Education and Fellowship.
11:00 am	Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in October

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1 World Communion Sunday 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 4:30p Young Families Dinner 7p SAA	2 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Finance 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study	3 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	4 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	5 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a What Do United Methodists Believe? 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	6 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6p SAA event 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA	7 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 9a SAA event 5p Childcare Event
8 Confirmation 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth Group 4p Living Brave 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	9 Columbus Day 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study	10 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council 6:30p Nokomis Prov.	11 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	12 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a What Do United Methodists Believe? 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	13 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	14 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 11a Carolee Eide Memorial
15 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA	16 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study 6:30p Women's Soul Group	17 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	18 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	19 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a What Do United Methodists Believe? 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 5:45p Will Party/ Funeral Planning	20 Newsletter items due 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	21 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 11a Carolee Eide Memorial
22 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 1p Congregational Workshop 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	23 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study	24 United Nations Day 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	25 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	26 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	27 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Colla-tion 10a Al-Anon 6p Halloween Party 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	28 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
29 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Living Brave 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA	30 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study	31 Halloween 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music	Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.			

Worship in October

October 1 is World Communion Sunday, and our focus this year will be the Caribbean. Come to hear and sing some Caribbean music and have some Caribbean styles of bread for communion. Oct. 8 is Confirmation Sunday where we welcome two more of our teens into membership. Through it all we'll be continuing our fall series – Mythbusters – where we find a better way to phrase some common things Christians say (but probably don't really mean).

1st **Mythbusters: It's God's Judgement**

Corinthians 5:10

World Communion Sunday

8th **Mythbusters: The Bible Clearly Says . . .**

Exodus 20:1-4, 7-10a, 12-17

Confirmation Sunday

15th **Mythbusters: God Will Never Give You More Than You Can Handle**

I Corinthians 10:12-13; John 14:1, 27

22nd **Mythbusters: There But for the Grace of God Go I**

Ephesians 2:8-9

29th *Becky on Vacation—Guest Preacher TBA*

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

Nov. 4 – Harvest Dinner and Concert by Timbre Junction

Nov. 5 – All Saints Sunday

Nov. 11 – Bazaar

Nov. 19 – Congregational Workshop

Nov. 22 – Thanksgiving Eve Worship Service

Dec. 8 – Blue Christmas Taizé

Dec. 17 – Christmas Pageant

Dec. 24 – One Worship Service in the morning at 10am

AND

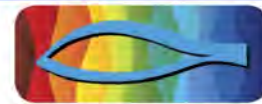
Christmas Eve services at 4pm and 10pm

Dec. 31 – One Worship Service at 10am

Jan. 10 – Food Shelf Pasta Dinner

Jan. 21 – Annual Meeting

Jan. 26-28 – Winter Retreat



Minnehaha Young Families
Ministries for families of babies & toddlers

Sunday, 1st October: Young Families Dinner at 4:30pm.

We'll gather together around the table to connect and to consider how we might grow as a community.

In the Minnehaha Fellowship Hall

RSVP at www.minnehahafamilies.wordpress.org

Sunday, 8th October: Young Families' Sunday School

Join us for a parent-child Sunday School Class – we'll sing together, have story time, learn a blessing, and other activities together.

10:15-11:00am in the Child Care Room (Room 204)

Congregational Workshops for Everyone

Everyone is essential to the life of a church. You might chair a committee, or be on a committee. Maybe you help teach Sunday School. Or you volunteer for various events. You pick up garbage you see on the floor and put it in the trash. You sing hymns in worship, have conversations with friends new and old. If you are part of this congregation, then these workshops are for you! We looked at the demographics of our neighborhood and our congregation in September; please join us for October and November as we continue to explore our relationship to our community:

- Sunday, Oct. 22, 1:00-3:00 – We say “All Are Welcome!” but how do we actually do that?
- Sunday, Nov. 19, 1:00-3:00 – How to be a true neighbor in our

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

October 20

October Youth Events at Minnehaha UMC

- **Oct. 1st Confirmation Class:** Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.
Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room talking about: *Intro Night - The Church*,
8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room talking about *Bible: Poetry & Wisdom*.
- **Oct. 8th Confirmation Sunday:**
Join us at our 9am worship to celebrate our newest members of the Church!
Cake reception to immediately follow in the Narthex.
- **Oct. 8th Youth night: Nerf Night at MUMC -**
All 6th-12th Grade welcome.
Goes from 4-6pm in the basement of the Church.
We will be playing all kinds of different team building games.
- **Oct. 13th Church Lock-in:** Our overnight adventure is for all grades 6th-12th and begins at 6pm.
Cost is \$10 per person to cover pizza for dinner as well as snacks and breakfast. Youth will be in for a night of exciting high energy games as well as lots of laughs and fellowship. Pick-up is after breakfast Saturday morning at 9am.
- **Oct. 15th Confirmation Class:** Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.
All grades are together for this class with Becky in the 3rd floor Youth Room talking about: *Conversations with Youth*.
- **Oct. 22nd Confirmation Class:** Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.
Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room discussing and planning the newest edition of *Youth News*,
8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room talking about *The Bible: Prophets*.
- **Oct. 26th Youth set-up Haunted House:** 6th-12th Grade From 6:00-8:00 pm in
Basement Hallway and Wesley room
- **Oct. 27th Church Halloween Party! -** All ages welcome
- **Oct. 29th Confirmation Class:** Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.
Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room filming the newest edition of *Youth News*,
8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room talking about *Judaism*.
- **Nov. 3-5 The Event: Mn United Methodist Conference for 6th-9th graders**
This is the new JUMY's if anybody remembers that. It is a weekend retreat at Cragun's Resort in Brainard that invites hundreds of United Methodist Youth from all over Minnesota to come together for fun and fellowship. It gives the Youth a chance to participate in a amazing conference where they can grow in their faith, connect with other youth, and build positive relationships with God and others. We are looking to bring at least 6 youth for us to attend, so please let me know right away if you are interested in sending your youth, or if you are interested in attending yourself as a chaperone! For more info contact Lani.



Children's Ministries

As we continue on with the new program year, we settle into routines at church. Many of us tend to sit in the same pews, take the same path to Sunday School, linger in the same areas. Routines can be a great comfort to us in a world that isn't usually in our control. These routines - this structure - offers security to our children as well. Knowing *what's* expected *when* reduces anxiety, and increases involvement.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

education@minnehaha.org

612.721.6231

This applies to our time in worship as well. For those of you who might have wondered why we don't have Sunday School at the same time as worship at Minnehaha - it's because we not only like having children as part of worship on the whole, but we also know how good it is for children to be a part of worship. Worship offers building blocks which will be essential as they continue to grow in their faith. So what are these building blocks? Here are just a few (there are countless more):

- They learn to take time from their

busy days, from running around, to focus on God, and to learn how to take God's love out into the world. One hour committed to learning and prayer, to praise and reflection, to offering and to blessing. One beautiful hour.

- They experience true intergenerational community, and know that they are a valued, celebrated part of this community. Look around the sanctuary during worship - see people of all ages together, listen to their voices come together in prayer or song. Greet one another with peace. There's not many other places in our daily lives where we have this kind of opportunity.
- They participate in rituals - the routines - of worship. Some rituals are an ancient and global part of Christianity - like saying the Lord's Prayer - while other rituals are more unique to Minnehaha. By coming and participating in worship each week, they hear the prayers, the joys and concerns of others, they hear commitments made to help them grow in baptismal promises, they hear scripture that gives words to what they might be feeling. The more they participate in these rituals, the more comfortable they become, and the more comfortable they become, the more at home they will be in worship, and the more at peace they are to explore their faith.

So, consider making worship part of your Sunday morning routine. And, take time to talk with your children about what you do in worship and why. And, please know that one of the wonderful things about Minnehaha is that people in the pews understand kids, and know that they might cry, or forget to whisper, or

As we go full steam into fall, there are a number of activities coming up that we hope you'll join us for:

- Saturday, September 30th: Minnehaha Autumn Outdoor Adventure: hike, explore, playground, picnic dinner with us at Lebanon Hills Park, from 3:30 to 6pm.
- Sunday, October 1st: Young Families Dinner for families with babies and toddlers. Dinner at Minnehaha at 4:30pm.
- Saturday, October 7th: Child Care Night & Parents' Night Out from 5pm
- Sunday, October 8th: Young Families Sunday School a parent-child Sunday School class
- Friday, October 27th: Halloween Party from 6-8pm

want to make funny faces at the people sitting behind them. They are welcomed and treasured.

Please let me know if you have any questions or concerns!

Happy Autumn,
Jenia Strom
Director of Children & Family Ministries

Highlights from the September 12 Church Council Meeting

On this day, we remember the terrible events of September 11, 2001, and hold all those affected in our thoughts and prayers.

TREASURER'S REPORT: We are where we should be. August contributions were weaker than last month, but still about 10% higher than August of last year. The church's net debt on the mortgage is down about 10% (\$34,186) so far in 2017. We are current with all bills, mortgage payments, apportionment payments and inter-fund loan payments through August 31, 2017. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)



HABITAT FOR HUMANITY DONATION: The church has had \$1,068 in a dedicated fund for Habitat for Humanity for more than two years. As our Treasurer pointed out, the money is not helping to build homes sitting in the church's bank account. As a result, the Council unanimously agreed to donate this money directly to Habitat for Humanity. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer; Annette Meier)

TAX DEDUCTIBILITY OF CONTRIBUTIONS TO "WHO IS OUR NEIGHBOR?" PROGRAM: In April of this year, the Minnehaha UMC Council passed legislation making the "Who Is Our Neighbor?" program (the church's partnership with a Somali family in Minneapolis) an official mission of the church. Since then, the question came up: Are contributions to the "Who Is Our Neighbor?" program tax deductible? The Finance committee discussed this and contacted the Minnesota Annual Conference of the United Methodist Church. The opinion of the Conference is that: "Designated contributions made to an approved project or program of the church, are deductible by a person that itemizes

deductions." To ensure deductibility, the Conference recommended that Minnehaha UMC adopt a resolution approving "Who Is Our Neighbor?" as a program within the mission of Minnehaha Church. (Which we'd already done on April 18, 2017.) The Conference also recommended that Minnehaha UMC name the group in charge of the program, and state that the group is charged to make sure "all funds contributed to the program are used in the furtherance of the program." At the meeting, the Church Council passed a resolution reaffirming the April 18 legislation, and also naming the Who Is Our Neighbor? Team as the group in charge of the Who Is Our Neighbor? program, and assigning them the responsibility to make sure all funds contributed to the program are used in the furtherance of the program. This motion passed. What does this mean? If you would like to give a gift to support the Who Is Our Neighbor? program at Minnehaha UMC and you itemize your taxes, your gift is tax deductible as long as you make your check payable to Minnehaha United Methodist Church and note that the contribution is for the Who Is Our Neighbor? program. (Sue Claude, Finance)



CONFIRMATION CLASSES BEGIN SEPT. 17: The new year of Confirmation kicks off September 17. This year we will have 26 youth participating in confirmation, with two planning to be confirmed this fall. (Lani Thompson, Youth Ministries)

FOOD SHELF PASTA DINNER ON JAN. 10: Mark your calendars for January 10 from 5:00 – 7:00 p.m. for the annual Pasta Dinner to support the Minnehaha Food Shelf. Food will once again be provided by Fat Lorenzo's, and the popular Accordion Band will return to play for the event. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)

Continued on pg. 9

United Methodist Women News



**United
Methodist
Women**

Our September Potluck was enjoyed by a great group of ladies (and Conrad!) who shared yummy corn dishes, brownies, salads and tales of summer adventures.

Circles will begin meeting in October with the Minnehaha Circle meeting on Wednesday, Oct. 11 at Nokomis Square in the commons room at 9:30

a.m.. If you're available to come, check it out; hostesses will be Wanda Driver, Mary Thompson and Joan Nordloef.

The Susanna Circle often meets in the evening with the time/date to be determined; if you're interested in joining this group, contact Sarah Emrick at 651-699-5914 or Sarah.emrick@outlook.com.

The Wenonah Circle, our service circle, always welcomes new members who would like to help prepare the church for funerals and other events; contact Kim Kanuit at 612-729-111 or kanuitkk@q.com. Be sure to get a table at the annual bazaar to sell your homemade items or other products; see info also in this newsletter about that event. Happy Autumn!

Conversations With the Bishop About Homosexuality

The 2016 General Conference called upon the Council of Bishops to guide The United Methodist Church in finding a "way forward" through the four-decade-long divide we have had on the matter of homosexuality. As a result, the Council formed a Commission on a Way Forward to assist the bishops with this task. The Commission will make its final report to the Council of Bishops in May, 2018 and the Council, in turn, will make its recommendation to a called session of the General Conference in February, 2019.

This Fall (September – November), our bishop (Bruce Ough) will be hosting 15 regional conversations across the Dakotas-Minnesota Area regarding the Commission's work. He is eager to (1) keep you informed about their deliberations and progress and, more significantly (2) gather your thoughts about a way forward. He is interested, among other things, to dialogue about how you see The United Methodist Church remaining united in the presence of significant cultural, regional and theological differences.

Please pre-register for the regional gathering you would like to attend. Your pre-registration will assist the host congregations to prepare appropriate meeting space and hospitality. You can register for any regional gathering that is convenient for you. Each gathering will last approximately two hours. Please register on-line by going to <https://mnumc-reg.brtaapp.com/Bishop71>. The dates for locations around the Twin Cities are listed below. If you have any questions, please contact Becky Sechrist, or you can also contact Sheilah Kyburz in the Area office (sheilah.kyburz@dkmnareaumc.org or 612-870-4007).

Bishop Ough looks forward to this opportunity to engage in this crucial conversation with you and urges us all to continue to pray seeking God's guidance and blessing for the Commission and the Council.

Schedule of meetings:

- Bloomington MN, Normandale Hylands UMC (9920 Normandale Blvd. S), Sat. Oct. 21, 10 a.m. to 12 p.m.
- Eagan MN, Advent UMC (3945 Lexington Ave. S), Wed. Oct. 25, 6:30-8:30 p.m.
- Roseville MN, Centennial UMC (1524 W County Rd. C2), Thurs. Nov. 2, 6:30-8:30 p.m.

Minnehaha's Autumn Outdoor Adventure

Who: All Ages Welcome

**When: Saturday, 30th September
3:30-6pm**

Where: Lebanon Hills Park, Jensen Lake Trailhead

**There's access to many hiking trails,
a great playground, and a canoe launch.
We'll gather to enjoy a beautiful autumn afternoon,
and encourage you to bring a picnic dinner along.
If weather doesn't cooperate, we'll reschedule.
This info will be on the website/FB Event.**

The Daud Family

Minnehaha voted last spring to form a partnership with the Daud family. A number of you have had a chance to meet the family in person, but since not everyone has had that chance yet, here is some information about them.

Fariyo & her husband came to Minnesota from Somalia by way of a refugee camp in Kenya. Although they still work hard at speaking English, their children are bilingual and sometimes translate for them. They own the Daud Diner, but with Fariyo and her husband holding down multiple other jobs, they do not operate the diner regularly now, using it primarily for catering. They have 5 children, 3 of whom we've had the opportunity to meet.

Their oldest son, Abdirahman is 23 and is in prison in Wisconsin, serving a 30 year sentence for participating in a plot to leave to United States and join ISIS. Neither the family nor Abdirahman consider him to have been "radicalized." They describe their son as a caring and compassionate young man and they believe he was entrapped by the FBI informants.

Abdirahman is awaiting the finalization of paperwork to enroll in college classes through a partnership with Oxford Prison and Ohio University. He will begin with one or preferably two classes and then proceed from there. He writes about that and other opportunities: "I am currently enrolled in the electrical apprenticeship program here at Oxford. It's a four year program. Many have received their masters as electricians before their release date and are currently working for major electrical companies. I have a lot at the electric shop, never thought I would enjoy it

so much. I can't wait to start college again. I have a lot of time on my hands and I refuse to waste it."

The Daud's daughter, Sundus is 16 and a junior at Columbia Heights High School. She is also taking 2 classes at MCTC community college. She receives credit at the college and at high school for these classes. Sundus' favorite dessert is Lava Cakes. Her favorite TV show is 'Game of Thrones'

Zach is 13 and is going into 8th grade at International Middle School. He is into basketball and his favorite animated TV show is Naruto.

Safwan is 6 years old. He starts first grade this fall. He goes to TIES which is an elementary school that shares a building with Zach's school. Safwan's favorite food is Mac and Cheese. His favorite TV show is PJ Masks.

Naema is Abdirahman's fiancée, and she recently started working at 3M.

The Dauds have all expressed appreciation for the support Minnehaha Church has given them. Abdirahman loves to get letters (and often responds to them as well), so if you have time and energy, go ahead and drop him even a short note. Be sure to indicate in the first sentence that you are from Minnehaha UMC -- this is important because he gets unpleasant letters from strangers which he doesn't read. Also, please don't discuss

politics or ask questions about his trial or the circumstances of his conviction. Assume that all your mail will first be read by prison officials (and possible government officials as well) before it gets to Abdirahman. Prisons have strict rules, for security reasons, regarding mail, so please use the address below exactly, and follow the instructions carefully.

Abdirahman's birthday was September 13, so feel free to wish him a happy belated birthday.

- Only letters on plain paper written in ink
- No homemade cards
- No staples, glue, or ribbon
- Envelopes must include a return address with your name and address **written** legibly

Abdirahman Daud
49785-298
Federal Correctional Institution
P.O. Box 1000
Oxford, WI 53952



As we get back into the routine of the program year, let's be sure to make time amidst the craziness for time together, for fun, for calm, for sanity's sake...

the Minnehaha Children's Council's
**Autumn Child Care at Minnehaha
& Parents' Night Out at
a Local Restaurant**

When: Saturday, 7th October from 5-8pm
Where: Child Care Provided at Minnehaha UMC

Cost:
\$25-1 child
\$35-2 children
\$40-3 children

For children up to 10 years of age
proceeds support the children & youth programs

PLEASE RSVP BY SEPTEMBER 30th
Online Registration Available – Link at
www.minnehaha.org
or by calling Jenia at 612.721.6231

Current Events

Join us Sundays for the Adult Faith Forum, which will be focusing on current events. We are trying out a new electronic curriculum that comes out each week with lessons based on the news. Meet in the back of the Fellowship Hall, join in the conversation, and give us your feedback on this as a regular topic.

Taizé

For some of you, the Sunday morning worship does not provide enough time for quiet, reflection, prayer and silence. We invite you to feed your soul with our monthly Taizé Service. The service is modeled after the worship services at the ecumenical community of Taizé, located in eastern France. The service has prayer, scripture, music, and silence. The songs have few words, sung repetitively, in order to allow for deep contemplation and prayer. Join us on Friday, October 13 at 7:00 or any 2nd Friday.

Continued from pg. 6

UMW'S ANNUAL HOLIDAY BAZAAR ON NOV. 11: Plan on attending the United Methodist Women's annual Holiday Bazaar on November 11 from 9:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m. There will be gifts, crafts, fine art, antiques, collectibles, food and more. And a Hawaiian theme! (Maureen Trepp, UMW Chair)



PARENT-CHILD SUNDAY SCHOOL CLASS IN OCTOBER: Children's Ministries will offer a parent-child Sunday School class in October. This is for families with babies and toddlers. The plan is to have a class each quarter. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)

ALL-CHURCH INTERGENERATIONAL HIKE ON SAT., SEPT. 30: Children's Ministries is hosting an all-church intergenerational hike on Saturday, September 30. Look for details! (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)

HARVEST HOMECOMING MEAL & BLUEGRASS CONCERT ON NOV. 4: Our annual Harvest Homecoming meal and concert will take place on November 4. The gathering/meal will begin at 5:30 p.m. and the concert by local bluegrass band Timbre Junction will begin at 7:00 p.m. Buy tickets! Invite your friends and neighbors! This is a great feel good event that supports the church. (Annette Meier, Events Coordinator)



NEXT MEETING IS OCTOBER 10: The next Church Council meeting will be October 10 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request. (Dean Ammerman, Church Council)

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Save the Date: "Will Party" and "Funeral Planning" on Thursday, October 19

SAVE THE DATE: "Will Party" and "Funeral Planning" on Thursday, October 19

On Thursday, October 19, starting at 5:45 pm with a light supper, Minnehaha UMC will host a "Will Party" and "Funeral Planning" event. All are invited to attend, young and old.

The "Will Party" portion will provide an opportunity for those who wish to start or revise a will to meet with an attorney. Steve Otto of Otto Law (www.ottoesq.com), a Twin Cities law firm focusing on estate planning/probate administration and business law, will be at the meeting to talk about wills, answer your questions, and to meet one-on-one to discuss your estate planning needs. (There is no charge for this initial consultation.) If you would like to have a will drawn up or do other estate planning, you can set up a follow-up meeting.

Following Steve Otto, Becky will walk us through the Funeral Planning materials the church uses. The forms are available on our website (see the tab under "building use" on the top), but sometimes it's helpful to walk through them in person. Whether you are jotting down notes you want to leave for your own service, or thinking about the questions you might need to ask a family member to help plan their service, this is a helpful piece of planning.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Sq.

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of some kind around current events in the world or in the church. In October we will be gathering on October 12.

What Do United Methodists Believe?

Although theology in the United Methodist Church is not a rigid thing, there are particular beliefs that define who we are. If you'd like to find out more about what United Methodists believe about concepts like heaven, hell, grace, baptism, etc., come on Thursday mornings from 10:00-11:00 a.m. The class starts on Sept. 14 and runs through Oct. 19. Join at any time!

Food Ministries

MUMC supports **two food ministries**. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

SAVE THE DATE! SAVE THE DATE! SAVE THE DATE! SAVE THE DATE!

Annual Holiday Bazaar

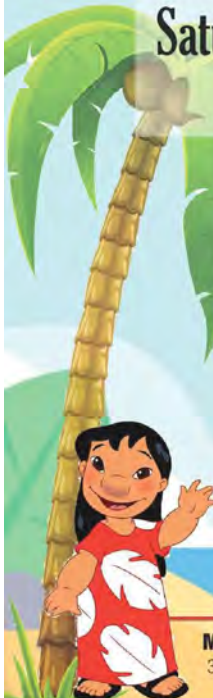
by the Minnehaha United Methodist Women

Mele Kalikimaka

(That's "Merry Christmas" in Hawaiian)

Saturday, November 11, 2017

9:00 a.m. — 2:00 p.m.



Gifts, Crafts, Fine Art, Antiques, Collectibles, Food and more!

BREAKFAST
9:00 — 11:00 a.m.
Egg Bake, Cinnamon Rolls

LUNCH
11:00 a.m. — 1:00 p.m.
Hot Dish, Sloppy Joes, Dessert Table

CHILDREN'S BOUTIQUE
9:00 a.m. — 1:00 p.m.
Fun gifts for children to select, wrap and give their parents at Christmas time.

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 East 50th Street • Minneapolis, MN 55417
(612) 721-6231 • www.minnehaha.org



A Lived Life

I've been doing some more sorting and cleaning out this summer and fall. My mother's youngest sister, my Aunt Sarah, was my only aunt who lived in town. My brother and I spent a lot of time with her when we were kids, but as we got busier and as my grandparents began spending more time in Arizona, we spent less time with my aunt. By the time I was back from school and my brother was back from the Army, we hardly ever saw her. I don't want to go into lots of details here, but suffice it to say that I don't think my aunt had a very happy childhood, and I don't think she had a very happy adulthood either. And she shared that unhappiness liberally with the world around her. She was hard on her friends, and when she had choices about whether or not to spend time with family, she chose not. A combination of physical limitations and her own personal choices resulted in her living in an ever-shrinking world. In her last 15 years, family interacted with her through particular roles. One of my other aunts managed her finances. My mother made sure that she was physically safe. Whenever she was in the hospital, my role was to go visit her. By the time she died this last May, her world and the choices available to her had become quite small. I think, seeing the handwriting on the wall, she gave up fighting. My brother and I, being the only family now in town, were with her when she died. But I doubt she was aware of our presence. And, as the family in town, we've been overseeing the packing up and getting rid of her belongings. I know all the stories my mom would tell about my aunt, but as I've been going through her things, I am aware that I have lots of questions. I wish she could have shared with me the stories behind the letters from camp friends that I found in a box. Or the stories from a trip she took in high school, which I only have a photo album of. Due to the afore-mentioned not so great childhood, my remaining aunts are not able to tell me those stories. It's quite possible that none of her sisters knew the things that really mattered to her or what she thought about a variety of things back when she was able to have those feelings and express those thoughts. Each time my brother and I need to deal with another piece of my aunt's estate, I come away from it sad. Sad for what was and sad for what might have been. I'm also sad that my brother and I appear to be the only relatives that have any positive memories of her. I hope she knew that we had fond feelings for her, but I fear she did not.

I say it at every funeral, and I really do believe that she is held firmly in the center of God now. I trust that all the pain she knew in this life has been replaced by the love and joy God has to offer. To all the people in this life that she hurt, all we can do is apologize and thank them for caring for her anyway. And so the sadness I feel is my own. I'm not worried about the state of her soul, or anything like that. I am profoundly glad that I believe she is in God's hands. And I am profoundly glad that I don't think she has to "pay" in the afterlife for the trauma she caused in this life. I don't think she deserves that any more than the people she hurt deserved what happened to them. But it does give me pause to think about my own life. How do I choose to live, given the cards I've been dealt? When life is unfair, what will I choose to do with that? Really, it boils down to what kind of person can I live with? I don't want to live with myself the way my aunt chose to live with herself. And so I pray every day for strength and wisdom to make different choices. And, I am profoundly glad to know that no matter how well I do that, God still loves me. That I, like my aunt, am firmly held in the center of God.

In joy,

Becky



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10/17

